

RUSSIAN REVOLUTION AND USSR UNDER STALIN

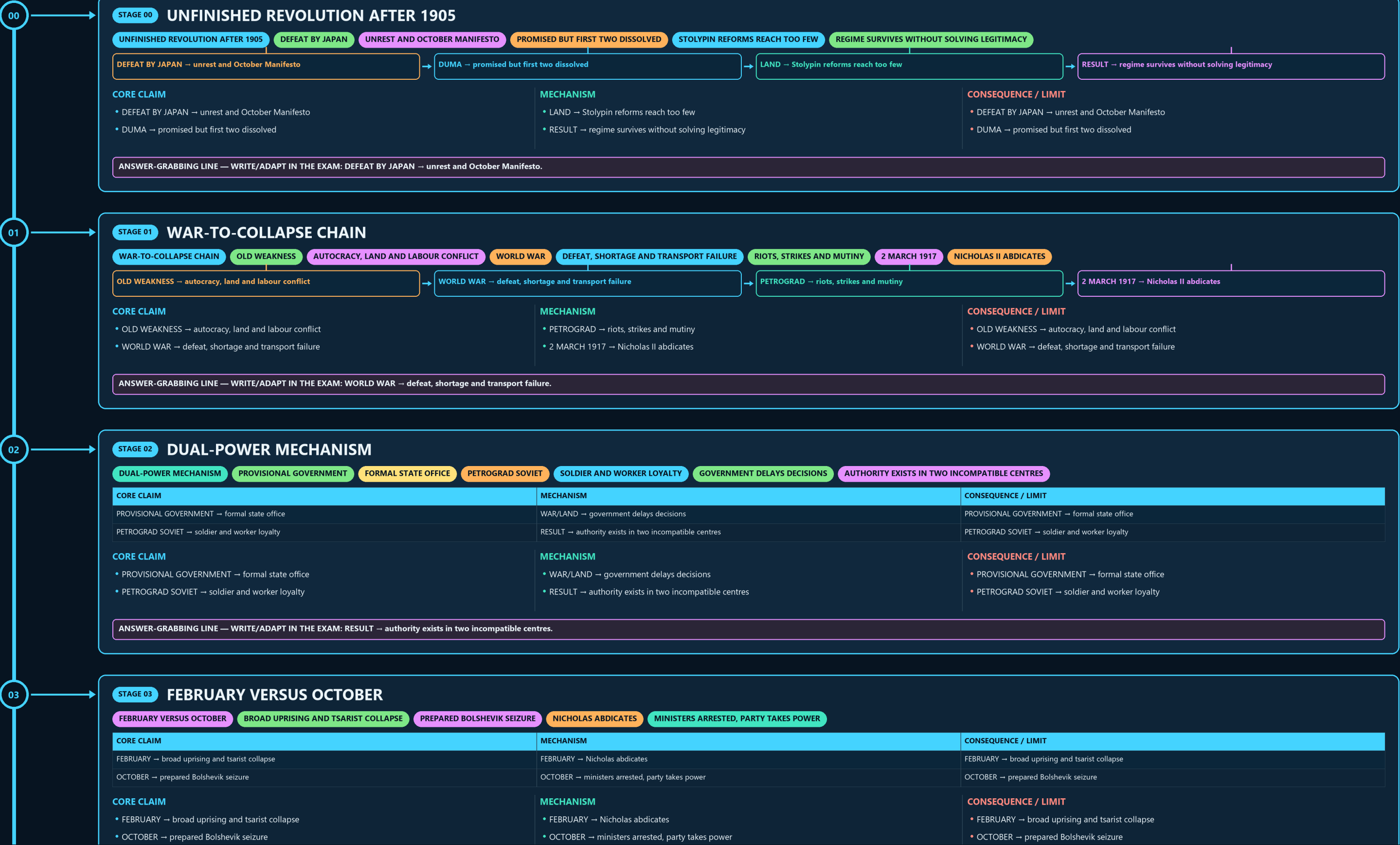
UNFINISHED REVOLUTION AFTER 1905 → WAR-TO-COLLAPSE CHAIN → DUAL-POWER MECHANISM → FEBRUARY VERSUS OCTOBER → PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT FAILURE → BOLSHEVIK CONSOLIDATION TOOLKIT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



- PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT → formal state office
- PETROGRAD SOVIET → soldier and worker loyalty

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → authority exists in two incompatible centres.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse	FEBRUARY → Nicholas abdicates	FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse
OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure	OCTOBER → ministers arrested, party takes power	OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure

- FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse
- OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FEBRUARY → Nicholas abdicates; OCTOBER → ministers arrested, party takes power.

- WAR CONTINUES → popular support falls
- LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls.

- DECREE → land and worker measures
- EXIT WAR → Brest-Litovsk, March 1918

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer	OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim	LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer
GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled	INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia	GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled

- LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer
- GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COERCION → Assembly dispersed, Cheka and Red Terror.

06

STAGE 06 WHY THE REDS WON

WHY THE REDS WON LENIN AND TROTSKY FIRMER CENTRAL RUSSIAN CORE CONTROLLED WHITES DIVIDED IN AIM REDS CLAIM DEFENCE OF RUSSIA

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer	OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim	LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer
GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled	INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia	GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled
CORE CLAIM - LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer - GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled	MECHANISM - OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim - INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer - GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim; INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia.

07

STAGE 07 NEP BOUNDARY

NEP BOUNDARY MARKET RETURNS PEASANT SURPLUS AND SMALL TRADE STATE RETAINS HEAVY INDUSTRY, BANKS AND TRANSPORT COMMUNIST MONOPOLY CONTINUES ECONOMIC RETREAT WITHOUT POLITICAL RETREAT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade	POLITICS → communist monopoly continues	MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade
STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport	VERDICT → economic retreat without political retreat	STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport
CORE CLAIM - MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade - STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport	MECHANISM - POLITICS → communist monopoly continues - VERDICT → economic retreat without political retreat	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade - STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport.

08

STAGE 08 STALIN'S RISE LADDER

STALIN'S RISE LADDER GENERAL SECRETARY ORGANISATIONAL NETWORK UNDERESTIMATE STALIN SHIFTING ALLIANCES TROTSKY ISOLATED FIRST KAMENEV, ZINOVIEV AND BUKHARIN REMOVED

GENERAL SECRETARY → organisational network	RIVALS → underestimate Stalin	SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first	END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed
CORE CLAIM - GENERAL SECRETARY → organisational network - RIVALS → underestimate Stalin	MECHANISM - SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first - END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - GENERAL SECRETARY → organisational network - RIVALS → underestimate Stalin	

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first; END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed.

09

STAGE 09 INDUSTRIALISATION AND COLLECTIVISATION

INDUSTRIALISATION AND COLLECTIVISATION FIVE YEAR PLANS HEAVY OUTPUT RISES SCARCITY AND DISCIPLINE PERSIST GRAIN CONTROL INCREASES RURAL COST RESISTANCE, LIVESTOCK LOSS AND FAMINE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises	COLLECTIVISATION → grain control increases	FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises
CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist	RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine	CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist
CORE CLAIM - FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises - CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist	MECHANISM - COLLECTIVISATION → grain control increases - RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises - CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first; END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed.

09

STAGE 09 INDUSTRIALISATION AND COLLECTIVISATION

INDUSTRIALISATION AND COLLECTIVISATION

FIVE YEAR PLANS

HEAVY OUTPUT RISES

SCARCITY AND DISCIPLINE PERSIST

GRAIN CONTROL INCREASES

RURAL COST

RESISTANCE, LIVESTOCK LOSS AND FAMINE

CORE CLAIM

FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises

CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist

MECHANISM

COLLECTIVISATION → grain control increases

RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises

CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist

CORE CLAIM

• FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises

• CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist

MECHANISM

• COLLECTIVISATION → grain control increases

• RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises

• CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine.

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STAGE 10 CONSTITUTION AND TERROR

CONSTITUTION AND TERROR

1936 CONSTITUTION

DEMOCRATIC APPEARANCE

ONE PARTY

NO REAL ELECTORAL COMPETITION

STALIN BECOMES UNCHALLENGEABLE

CAPABILITY COST

OFFICERS AND OFFICIALS REMOVED

CORE CLAIM

1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance

ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition

MECHANISM

PURGES → Stalin becomes unchallengeable

CAPABILITY COST → officers and officials removed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance

ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition

CORE CLAIM

• 1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance

• ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition

MECHANISM

• PURGES → Stalin becomes unchallengeable

• CAPABILITY COST → officers and officials removed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• 1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance

• ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PURGES → Stalin becomes unchallengeable; CAPABILITY COST → officers and officials removed.

11

STAGE 11 REVOLUTION-TO-STALIN ANSWER SPINE

REVOLUTION-TO-STALIN ANSWER SPINE

UNRESOLVED 1905 ORDER PLUS WAR

DUAL POWER AND ORGANISED OCTOBER

DECREE, COERCION, CIVIL WAR AND NEP

INDUSTRY, COLLECTIVISATION AND TERROR

COLLAPSE → unresolved 1905 order plus war

SEIZURE → dual power and organised October

CONSOLIDATION → decree, coercion, Civil War and NEP

TRANSFORMATION → industry, collectivisation and terror

CORE CLAIM

• COLLAPSE → unresolved 1905 order plus war

• SEIZURE → dual power and organised October

MECHANISM

• CONSOLIDATION → decree, coercion, Civil War and NEP

• TRANSFORMATION → industry, collectivisation and terror

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• COLLAPSE → unresolved 1905 order plus war

• SEIZURE → dual power and organised October

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSOLIDATION → decree, coercion, Civil War and NEP.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

GEORGE KATKOV STRESSES ELITE CONSPIRACY AND ABDICATION FROM ABOVE

W. H. CHAMBERLIN STRESSES A LEADERLESS, SPONTANEOUS UPRISING FROM

LATER HISTORIANS HIGHLIGHTED WORKERS' MATERIAL GRIEVANCES MORE THAN PARTY

DISPERSED THE CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY

JUSTIFIED EXECUTIONS AND COERCION

BANNED FACTIONALISM WITHIN THE PARTY.

"SOCIALISM IN ONE COUNTRY" VERSUS "PERMANENT REVOLUTION"

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

• George Katkov stresses elite conspiracy and abdication from above;

• W. H. Chamberlin stresses a leaderless, spontaneous uprising from below;

• later historians highlighted workers' material grievances more than party direction.

• dispersed the Constituent Assembly;

ADVANCED DEBATE

• justified executions and coercion;

• banned factionalism within the party.

• "socialism in one country" versus "permanent revolution";

• continuation of NEP versus rapid industrialization.

LEGACY / NUANCE

• Robert Conquest offers very high estimates;

• official post-Soviet data suggest lower but still enormous totals;

• Ronald Suny's wider counting pushes the destroyed lives still higher when famine is included.

• "Inevitable revolution" is a historiographical question, not a settled factual statement.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.